

Troparia and Kontakia for the Great Feasts in Chronological Order

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Feasts in order of occurrence in the church year:

- September 8, Nativity of the Theotokos
- September 14, Exaltation of the Cross
- November 21, Presentation or Entry of the Theotokos
- December 25, Nativity of Christ/Christmas
- January 6, Baptism of Christ -- Theophany, also called Epiphany
- February 2, Presentation of Jesus at the Temple, or Meeting of the Lord
- March 25, Annunciation
- Sunday before Pascha -- Entry into Jerusalem or Palm Sunday
- Forty Days after Pascha -- Ascension of Christ
- Fifty Days after Pascha -- Pentecost
- August 6, Transfiguration
- August 15, Dormition (Falling Asleep) of the Theotokos

Nativity of the Theotokos, September 8

Troparion Tone IV: Thy nativity, O Theotokos Virgin, / hath proclaimed joy to all the world; / for from thee hath dawned the Sun of righteousness, Christ our God, / annulling the curse, and bestowing the blessing, // abolishing death and granting us life everlasting.

Kontakion Tone IV: Joachim and Anna were freed from the reproach of childlessness / and Adam and Eve from the corruption of death, / by thy holy nativity, O immaculate one, / which thy people, redeemed from the guilt of offences, / celebrate by crying to thee: / The barren woman giveth birth to the Theotokos, // the nourisher of our life.

Entry of the Theotokos, November 21

Troparion Tone IV: Today is the prelude of God's good will / and the heralding of the salvation of mankind. / In the temple of God the Virgin is presented openly, / and she proclaimeth Christ unto all. / To her, then, with a great voice let us cry aloud: / Rejoice, O thou fulfillment // of the Creator's dispensation!

Kontakion Tone IV: The most pure temple of the Savior, / the most precious bridal chamber and Virgin, / the sacred treasury of the glory of God, / is on this day brought into the house of the Lord, / bringing with her the grace that is in the divine Spirit. / And the angels of God chant praise unto her: // she is the heavenly tabernacle.

Annunciation, March 25

Troparion Tone IV: Today is the fountainhead of our salvation / and the manifestation of the mystery which was from eternity. / The Son of God becometh the Virgin's Son, / and Gabriel proclaimeth the good tidings of grace. / Wherefore, we also cry to the Theotokos with him: / Rejoice, thou who art full of grace, // the Lord is with thee!

Kontakion Tone VIII: To thee, the Champion Leader, we thy servants dedicate / a feast of victory and of thanksgiving, / as ones rescued out of sufferings, O Theotokos. / But as thou art one with might which is invincible, / from all dangers that can be do thou deliver us, // that we may cry to thee: Rejoice, thou Bride unwedded.

Nativity of the Savior, December 25

Troparion Tone IV: Thy Nativity, O Christ our God, / hath shone forth the light of knowledge upon the world; / for therein those who worship the stars / have been taught by a star / to worship Thee, the Son of righteousness, / and to know Thee, the Dayspring from on high. // O Lord, glory be to Thee.

Kontakion Tone III: Today the Virgin giveth birth / to the Transcendent One, / and the earth offereth a cave / to the unapproachable One. / Angels with shepherds give glory; / the Magi journey with the star. / For our sakes a young Child is born, // Who is preeternal God!

Meeting of the Lord, February 2

Troparion Tone I: Rejoice, O Virgin Theotokos, full of grace, / for from thee hath shone forth Christ our God, the Sun of Righteousness, / Who doth illumine those in darkness. / Be glad, thou also, O righteous elder / who receivest in thine arms the Deliverer of our souls, // Who granteth us resurrection.

Kontakion Tone I: O Thou Who didst hallow the Virgin's womb by Thy birth / and didst bless the hands of Symeon as was meet, / by anticipation Thou hast even now saved us, O Christ God. / But in the midst of battle grant peace to Thy community, / and strengthen the Orthodox Christians whom Thou hast loved, // O Thou Who alone lovest mankind.

Theophany, January 6

Troparion Tone I: When Thou wast baptized in the Jordan, O Lord, / the worship of the Trinity was made manifest: / for the voice of the Father bore witness unto Thee, / calling Thee His beloved Son; / and the Spirit in the form of a dove / confirmed the certainty of the word. / O Christ God, Who hast appeared and enlightened the world, // glory be to Thee!

Kontakion Tone IV: Thou hast appeared today to the whole world, / and Thy light, O Lord, hath been signed upon us / who hymn Thee with understanding. / Thou hast come, Thou hast appeared, // the Light unapproachable.

Transfiguration, August 6

Troparion Tone VII: Thou wast transfigured on the mountain, O Christ God, / Who didst show Thy glory unto Thy disciples as far as they could bear it. / May Thine ever-existing light / shine forth also upon us sinners / through the prayers of the Theotokos. // O Bestower of light, glory be to Thee!

Kontakion Tone VII: On the mountain wast Thou transfigured, / and Thy disciples beheld Thy glory as far as they could bear it, O Christ God; / that when they would see Thee crucified, / they would comprehend that Thy suffering was voluntary, / and proclaim to the world that Thou art of a truth // the Effulgence of the Father.

Palm Sunday

Troparion Tone I: In confirming the common Resurrection, O Christ God, / Thou didst raise up Lazarus from the dead before Thy Passion. / Wherefore, we also like the children, bearing the symbols of victory, / cry to Thee, the Vanquisher of death: / Hosanna in the highest, // blessed is He that cometh in the Name of the Lord.

Kontakion Tone VI Seated in heaven upon Thy throne and on earth upon a foal, O Christ our God, Thou hast accepted the praise of the angels and the songs of the children who cried out to Thee: Blessed art Thou that comest to call back Adam.

Exaltation of the Holy Cross, September 14

Troparion Tone I: O Lord, save Thy people / and bless Thine inheritance. / Grant victory to the Orthodox Christians / over their adversaries, / and by the power of Thy Cross, // preserve Thy habitation.

Kontakion Tone IV: O Thou Who wast lifted up willingly upon the Cross, / bestow Thy compassions upon the new community named after Thee, O Christ God; / gladden with Thy power the Orthodox Christians, / granting them victory over enemies; // may they have as Thy help the weapon of peace, the invincible trophy.

Pascha

Troparion Christ is risen from the dead, trampling down death by death, and on those in the tombs bestowing life.

Tone 8 Kontakion: Though Thou didst descend into the grave, O Immortal One, yet didst Thou destroy the power of hades. And didst arise as victor, O Christ God, calling to the myrrh-bearing women: Rejoice! And giving peace unto Thine apostles: Thou Who dost grant resurrection to the fallen.

Resurrection Troparia and Kontakia in the 8 Tones

Troparion of the Resurrection. First Tone .

When the stone had been sealed by the Jews, and the soldiers where guarding Thine immaculate Body, Thou didst rise on the third day, O Savior, granting life unto the world. Wherefore, the Hosts of the Heavens cried out to Thee, O Life-giver: Glory to Thy Resurrection, O Christ. Glory to Thy kingdom. Glory to Thy dispensation, O only Lover of mankind.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. First Tone .

As God Thou didst arise from the tomb in glory, and Thou didst raise the world together with Thyself. And mortal nature praiseth Thee as God, and death hath vanished. And Adam danceth, O Master, and Eve, now freed from fetters, rejoiceth as she crieth out: Thou art He, O Christ, that grantest unto all resurrection.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Second Tone .

When Thou didst descend unto death, O Life Immortal, then didst Thou slay Hades with the lightning of Thy Divinity. And when Thou didst also raise the dead out of the nethermost depths, all the Hosts of Heavens cried out: O Lifegiver, Christ our God, glory be to Thee.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Second Tone .

Thou didst arise from the tomb, O omnipotent Savior, and Hades was terrified on beholding the wonder; and the dead arose, and creation at the sight thereof rejoiceth with Thee. And Adam also is joyful, and world, O my Savior, praiseth Thee for ever.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Third Tone .

Let the heavens be glad; let earthly things rejoice; for the Lord hath wrought might with His arm. He hath trampled down death by death; the first-born of the dead hath He become. From the belly of Hades hath He delivered us and hath granted to the world great mercy.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Third Tone .

Thou didst rise today from the tomb, O Merciful One, and didst lead us out of the gates of death. Today Adam danceth and Eve rejoiceth; and together with them both the Prophets and Patriarchs unceasingly praise the divine might of Thine authority.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Fourth Tone .

Having learned the joyful proclamation of the Resurrection from the angel, and having cast off the ancestral condemnation, the women disciples of the Lord spake to the apostles exultantly: Death is despoiled and Christ God is risen, granting to the world great mercy.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Fourth Tone .

My Savior and Redeemer hath, as God, raised up the earthborn from the grave and from their fetters, and He hath broken the gates of Hades, and, Master, hath risen on the third day.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Fifth Tone .

Let us, O faithful, praise and worship the Word Who is co-unoriginate with the Father and the Spirit, and Who was born of the Virgin for our salvation; for He was pleased to ascend the Cross in the flesh and to endure death, and to raise the dead by His glorious Resurrection

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Fifth Tone .

Unto Hades, O my Savior, didst Thou descend, and having broken its gates as One omnipotent, Thou, as Creator, didst raise up the dead together with Thyself. And Thou didst break the sting of death, and didst deliver Adam from the curse, O Lover of mankind. Wherefore, we all cry unto Thee: Save us, O Lord.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Sixth Tone .

Angelic Hosts were above Thy tomb, and they that guarded Thee became as dead. And Mary stood by the grave seeking Thine immaculate Body. Thou didst despoil Hades and wast not tempted by it. Thou didst meet the Virgin and didst grant us life. O Thou Who didst rise from the dead, O Lord, glory be to Thee.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Sixth Tone .

Having by His life-bestowing hand raised up all the dead out of the dark abysses, Christ God, the Giver of Life, hath bestowed the Resurrection upon the fallen human race; for He is the Savior of all, the Resurrection, and the Life, and the God of all.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Seventh Tone .

Thou didst destroy death by Thy Cross, Thou didst open Paradise to the thief. Thou didst change the lamentation of the Myrrh-bearers, and Thou didst command Thine Apostles to proclaim that Thou didst arise, O Christ God, and grantest to the world great mercy.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Seventh Tone .

No longer will the dominion of death be able to keep men captive; for Christ hath descended, demolishing and destroying the powers thereof. Hades is bound; the Prophets rejoice with one voice, saying: A Savior hath come for them that have faith. Come forth, ye faithful, for the Resurrection.

Troparion of the Resurrection. Eighth Tone .

From on high didst Thou descend, O Compassionate One; to burial of three days hast Thou submitted that Thou mightest free us from our passions. O our Life and Resurrection, O Lord, glory be to Thee.

Kontakion of the Resurrection. Eighth Tone .

Having arisen from the tomb, Thou didst raise up the dead and didst resurrect Adam. Eve also danceth at Thy Resurrection, and the ends of the world celebrate Thine arising from the dead, O Greatly-merciful One.

Ascension

Kontakion Tone VIII: Once, when He descended and confounded the tongues, the Most High divided the nations; / and when He divided the tongues of fire, He called all men into unity; // and with one accord we glorify the All-holy Spirit.

Kontakion Tone VI: When Thou hadst fulfilled Thy dispensation for our sakes, / uniting things on earth with the Heavens, / Thou didst ascend in glory, O Christ our God, / departing not hence, / but remaining inseparable from us / and crying unto them that love Thee: // I am with you, and no one can be against you.

Pentecost

Troparion Tone VIII: Blessed art Thou, O Christ our God, / Who hast shown forth the fishermen as supremely wise / by sending down upon them the Holy Spirit, / and through them didst draw the world into Thy net. // O Befriender of man, glory be to Thee.

Kontakion Tone VIII: Once, when He descended and confounded the tongues, the Most High divided the nations; / and when He divided the tongues of fire, He called all men into unity; // and with one accord we glorify the All-holy Spirit.

Dormition, August 15

Troparion Tone 1 In giving birth thou didst preserve thy virginity, / in thy dormition thou didst not forsake the world, O Theotokos. / Thou wast translated unto life, / thou who art the Mother of Life. // And by thine intercessions dost thou redeem our souls from death

Kontakion Tone 2 The tomb and mortality / could not hold the Theotokos, / who is untiring in her supplications / and our certain hope in her intercessions. / For, as the Mother of Life, she hath passed over to the Life // Who dwelt within her ever-virgin womb.

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